

SharpAPI for NFL player props

What it is, what the free plan actually gives you, and how to wire it into an app the same way we wired up a props feed before.

The short version

SharpAPI is a company that watches real sportsbooks and hands you their betting lines in a form a program can read. You sign up, they give you a key, and your app asks them for tonight's lines whenever it wants.

Yes, it does NFL player props. Passing yards, rushing yards, receiving yards, touchdowns, completions, interceptions, receptions, and combination props — from whichever sportsbooks offer them.

There is a genuinely free plan. No credit card. It is limited, but the limits are the useful kind — see the next page.

Read this before you rely on anything below

Everything in this document about SharpAPI's plans, limits and coverage comes from **SharpAPI's own website**. The machine this was written on cannot open outside websites — the network blocks it — so nobody here has read their technical documentation or seen the service answer a single request.

That means: treat this as a well-researched starting point, not as verified fact. The first thing to do is sign up for the free plan and check the details yourself. Ten minutes there beats any amount of reading here.

Exact web addresses for their endpoints are deliberately **not** listed in this document, because guessing them would be worse than leaving them out. Their documentation has them.

Why a sportsbook feed beats a pick'em app

This is the part worth understanding, because it changes what your app can actually tell you.

A pick'em app (PrizePicks, Underdog, Sleeper) shows you a player and a number, and you say higher or lower. No individual pick has a price on it — the payout depends on how many picks you bundle together. So the app gives you a line, and nothing else.

A real sportsbook (DraftKings, FanDuel) puts a price on every single bet. That price is really a statement of odds: it is the bookmaker telling you what they believe the chances are.

If your app produces its own number — say, a simulation that says a receiver goes over 60 yards 62% of the time — you need something to compare it against. A sportsbook price gives you that for free, on every bet, from people whose entire business is getting it right. A pick'em app does not, which means you have to invent the comparison yourself and hope your assumption is sound.

That is the single biggest reason to prefer this over scraping a pick'em app.

What the free plan gives you

All figures below are from SharpAPI's pricing and comparison pages.

Cost	Free. No credit card required.
Sportsbooks	Two — DraftKings and FanDuel.
How often you can ask	About 12 times per minute. There is no monthly cap to run out of.
Freshness	Odds arrive about 60 seconds behind live.
Which odds	Pre-match only. Live in-game odds are on the paid plans.
Player props	Included, across the sports they cover.
Paid plans	Roughly \$79/month for live odds and more sportsbooks; about \$229/month for their value-betting features.

Why the “12 times a minute” limit is the good kind

Most free plans elsewhere cap you at a certain number of requests per *month*. That sounds generous and isn't: an app that checks a full slate of games repeatedly through the day burns a month's allowance in an afternoon, and then goes dark until the calendar flips.

A speed limit works completely differently. You can keep going forever as long as you don't ask too fast. Twelve times a minute is around seventeen thousand a day, which is far more than a slate needs.

This is the main reason to start here rather than with the alternatives.

The two limits that will actually bite

- **Pre-match only.** The free plan gives you the lines before kickoff, not while the game is running. If live betting is the point of your app, the free plan will not do it and you will need a paid one.
- **Two sportsbooks.** DraftKings and FanDuel only. Fine for one opinion on a line; not enough to compare books against each other and hunt for the outlier.
- **Sixty seconds behind.** Almost certainly irrelevant for comparing against your own model, which takes longer than that to run anyway. It would matter only if you were trying to grab a line the instant it moved.

How you connect (in plain terms)

You sign up and they give you a key — a long string of characters that acts as your password. Every time your app asks for data, it sends that key along so they know it's you.

Their documentation describes sending it as a header named X-API-Key, and says requests go to `api.sharpapi.io` — not the plain website address.

They also publish a machine-readable description of the whole service (an OpenAPI file). Grab that early: you can hand it straight to Claude Code and it will know every available endpoint and the exact shape of every response, without anyone guessing.

How to wire it in

This is the shape that worked for us on a props feed, and it will transfer. The order of these steps is the part that matters.

1. Prove you can reach it before you build anything

Write one small piece of code whose only job is to ask for data and report exactly what came back — did it answer, how many items, what were the field names, and one complete example. Put it behind a web address in your own app so you can hit it from a browser.

Do this first. It is tempting to skip, and skipping it is how you end up debugging a parser for two days when the real problem was that nothing ever arrived. It also means your app can be checked against reality later, when something changes and nobody knows why the board went empty.

2. Translate their words into your words — in one place

They will call a market something like “Player Reception Yards”. Your app has its own name for that. Keep a single lookup table that maps one to the other, and **count everything you throw away, by name**.

That counting sounds fussy and is the most valuable thing in this document. When someone says “I can see this prop in the app and it's not on your page”, there are several possible reasons that look identical from the outside — the feed never sent it, you didn't recognise the market name, or the player isn't in a lineup you know about. If you count each one separately you get an answer in seconds. If you don't, you get guesswork. We lost the better part of a week to exactly this.

3. Drop what you can't handle — loudly, never silently

There will be markets you can't use. Refuse them rather than forcing them into the nearest slot, and record that you refused. A wrong number that looks reasonable is far more damaging than a missing one.

4. Ask for all of it

Feeds hand back results a page at a time. If you only read the first page, you get a fraction of the board — and it looks exactly like a quiet night rather than a bug. Keep asking until there is nothing left, and be suspicious of any round number.

5. Cache briefly

Hold the answer for something like a minute so that ten people opening your page doesn't mean ten requests. With a speed limit rather than a monthly cap this is about being a good citizen more than about conserving anything.

One thing that will be easier than it was for us

Because these are real sportsbook prices, each bet arrives with odds attached. You do not have to invent a break-even number to compare your model against — the comparison arrives with the data.

If you have looked at a pick'em version of this and wondered where a figure like “needs 57.7%” came from, that was an assumption someone had to make because the feed carried no price. With SharpAPI that assumption disappears.

Links

Start with the first two. The NFL page is the one that lists the props on offer.

NFL props and markets

<https://sharpapi.io/odds/nfl>

What they cover for NFL — start here

Documentation

<https://docs.sharpapi.io/>

The real technical detail, including exact endpoints

Pricing and free tier

<https://sharpapi.io/pricing>

Confirm the free plan's limits yourself

Free plans compared

<https://sharpapi.io/compare/free-sports-odds-api>

Their own comparison against rivals — read with that in mind

Sportsbooks covered

<https://sharpapi.io/sportsbooks>

Which books, and on which plan

FanDuel coverage

<https://sharpapi.io/sportsbooks/fanduel-odds-api>

One of the two books on the free plan

Python walkthrough

<https://sharpapi.io/learn/sports-betting-api-python>

Their own getting-started tutorial

Terms of service

<https://sharpapi.io/terms>

Worth a look before building on it

Paste this into Claude Code

A starting brief for whoever is building it. It deliberately tells Claude to check the documentation rather than trust this summary.

I want to add NFL player props to this app using SharpAPI (sharpapi.io). I have a free-tier key.

Before writing the parser, read their docs at docs.sharpapi.io and confirm the actual endpoint paths, parameters and response shape. Do not guess them, and do not trust my summary below -- it came from their marketing pages, not their docs.

What I believe is true, for you to verify:

- base address is api.sharpapi.io
- the key goes in a header called X-API-Key
- free tier: DraftKings + FanDuel, pre-match only, ~60s delayed, about 12 requests per minute
- NFL props include passing/rushing/receiving yards, touchdowns, completions, interceptions, receptions

Build it in this order:

1. A probe endpoint FIRST. It should report whether the service answered, how many items came back, the field names present, and one complete example -- with no interpretation on top. I want to hit it in a browser.
2. A parser with a single lookup table from their market names to mine. Count every dropped item BY REASON and expose those counts. I need to tell 'they never sent it' apart from 'we failed to read it'.
3. Page through all results. Never stop at the first page.
4. Cache the board for ~60 seconds.

Rules: drop anything you cannot map rather than forcing it into the closest match. Never invent a price or a line. If the feed is unreachable, say so explicitly rather than returning an empty list that looks like a quiet slate.

If SharpAPI doesn't work out

Briefly, the others that were looked at, and why they lost:

- **The Odds API** — free allowance is small and player props appear to cost extra. Roughly five full checks a month. Not usable.
- **SportsGameOdds** — reasonable speed, but the free monthly allowance is tiny.
- **OddsPapi** — claims free props, but nearly all the information available about them is their own advertising.
- **PrizePicks** — free and reachable, but it is a pick'em app, so there are no prices. Fine for seeing what lines exist; no help for judging whether one is worth taking.
- **Underdog Fantasy** — no public way in at all.